



2026

History & Geography

Grade 5 · Paper 3 of 4

Theme: British Rule, Indentured Labour & Natural Resources of Mauritius

Time allowed: **1 hour** Total marks: **50**

Name: _____

Class: _____ Date: _____

Instructions to Candidates

1. Write your name, class and date in the spaces above.
2. Answer **all** questions in all three sections.
3. For tick-box questions, place a clear tick (✓) in the box next to your chosen answer.
4. Write your answers neatly in the spaces provided. Do not write outside the answer boxes.
5. The marks available for each question are shown in the box on the right.
6. Read each question carefully before you answer.

Mark allocation: Section A — History (25 marks) | Section B — Geography (15 marks) | Section C — Civics (10 marks)

Section A — History of Mauritius [25 marks]

1 For each question below, tick (✓) ONE correct answer.

(a) In which year did Britain capture Mauritius from France?

1

☐ 1800

☐ 1810

☐ 1835

☐ 1850

(b) The British abolished slavery in Mauritius in which year?

1

☐ 1810

☐ 1834

☐ 1835

☐ 1921

(c) From which country did most indentured labourers come to work in Mauritius?

1

☐ China

☐ Africa

☐ India

☐ Indonesia

(d) The Aapravasi Ghat in Port Louis is recognised by UNESCO because it was the landing station for which group of workers?

1

☐ British colonial officers

☐ Enslaved Africans

☐ Indian indentured labourers

☐ Chinese traders

2 Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

5

"When slavery was abolished in 1835, the British sugar planters in Mauritius needed new workers for their fields. They turned to India. Between 1834 and 1921, approximately 450,000 Indian men, women and children arrived in Mauritius under the *indenture* system. Workers signed contracts to labour on sugar estates for five years in exchange for a small wage, basic housing and food. Most came from the Indian states of Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Madras. The Aapravasi Ghat in Port Louis was the immigration depot where these workers first set foot in Mauritius. Today it is a UNESCO World Heritage Site, recognising the importance of this great migration of peoples across the Indian Ocean."

- (a)** According to the passage, how many Indian workers came to Mauritius under the indenture system? [1 mark]

- (b)** Name TWO things that indentured workers received in exchange for their five years of labour, as stated in the passage. [2 marks]

- (c)** What is the Aapravasi Ghat, and why is it important today? [2 marks]

- 3 Describe THREE effects of British colonisation on Mauritius.** Write two or three sentences for each effect. 6

(a) Effect 1:

(b) Effect 2:

(c) Effect 3:

- 4 Answer the following short questions about the British period in Mauritius.** 5

(a) Name the naval battle in 1810 near Mauritius in which France defeated Britain, before Britain later won the war and took the island.

[1 mark]

(b) Give TWO differences between an *indentured labourer* and an *enslaved person*. [2 marks]

(c) In which year did the indenture system finally end in Mauritius? [1 mark]

(d) Name ONE official language introduced by the British that is still used in Mauritius today. [1 mark]

5 **Explain how the arrival of Indian indentured labourers changed the society and culture of Mauritius.** Refer to at least TWO specific changes in your answer. 5

Section B — Geography of Mauritius [15 marks]

6 Tick (✓) ONE correct answer for each question.

(a) Which crop has been the most important agricultural product of Mauritius for over two centuries?

1

- ☐ Rice
- ☐ Sugar cane
- ☐ Tea
- ☐ Cotton

(b) Mauritius is surrounded by coral reefs. What important natural resource do these reefs help to protect?

1

- ☐ Fresh water supplies
- ☐ Coastal fishing and marine life
- ☐ Underground oil reserves
- ☐ Tropical forests

(c) Which natural resource from the sea is an important industry in Mauritius, providing food and income for many families?

1

- ☐ Salt mining
- ☐ Coral harvesting
- ☐ Fishing and seafood
- ☐ Oil drilling

7 Answer the following questions about the natural resources of Mauritius.

6

(a) Name THREE natural resources found in or around Mauritius. For each one, state how it is used. [3 marks — 1 mark each]

(b) Sugar cane has been farmed in Mauritius for hundreds of years. Give ONE advantage and ONE disadvantage of depending heavily on a single crop like sugar cane. [2 marks]

- (c) Tourism is sometimes called a "natural resource" of Mauritius. Explain why. Give ONE reason. [1 mark]

- 8 **Mauritius faces threats to its natural environment.** For each threat named below, describe ONE way in which people or the government can protect the environment. 6

- (a) **Threat:** Coral reef damage caused by pollution and fishing.

Protection:

[2 marks]

- (b) **Threat:** Destruction of native forests and loss of rare animal species.

Protection:

[2 marks]

- (c) **Threat:** Plastic waste polluting beaches and the ocean.

Protection:

[2 marks]

Section C — Civics & Community [10 marks]

9 Tick (✓) ONE correct answer for each question.

(a) Which Hindu festival of lights is celebrated in Mauritius, usually in October or November?

1

- ☐ Eid ul-Fitr
- ☐ Diwali
- ☐ Christmas
- ☐ Chinese New Year

(b) The national motto of Mauritius is "*Stella Clarisque Maris Indici*." What does this mean in English?

1

- ☐ "Freedom, Justice, Unity"
- ☐ "Star and Key of the Indian Ocean"
- ☐ "Land of Sun and Sea"
- ☐ "One People, One Nation"

(c) What is the role of a **local council** (village council) in Mauritius?

1

- ☐ To make laws for the whole country
- ☐ To manage and improve local services in a community
- ☐ To collect taxes for the government
- ☐ To control the police

(d) Which Mauritian institution is responsible for making the laws of the country?

1

- ☐ The Supreme Court
- ☐ The National Assembly (Parliament)
- ☐ The President's Office
- ☐ The District Council

10 Answer the following questions about community life in Mauritius.

6

(a) What is meant by the word "**community**"? Give ONE example of how community members in Mauritius help each other. [2 marks]

- (b) Name TWO responsibilities that a good citizen of Mauritius should carry out. For each one, explain why it matters. [4 marks]

Responsibility 1:

Responsibility 2:

Mark Scheme — Paper 3 (British Rule, Indentured Labour & Natural Resources)

For teacher / parent use only. Accept any answer that is factually correct and shows understanding. Award the second mark in a 2-mark question for development/explanation beyond a bare statement.

Q	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
1(a)	1810	1
1(b)	1835	1
1(c)	India	1
1(d)	Indian indentured labourers	1
2(a)	Approximately 450,000 (accept "around 450,000" or "half a million")	1
2(b)	Any TWO from: a small wage / basic housing / food. (1 mark each)	2
2(c)	The Aapravasi Ghat was the immigration depot / landing station in Port Louis where indentured labourers first arrived in Mauritius (1 mark). It is important today because it is a UNESCO World Heritage Site that commemorates this major migration / it is a museum / it honours the history of Indian workers (1 mark).	2
3(a–c)	Any THREE from: slavery was abolished (1835); indentured labourers brought from India, changing the population; English introduced as official language; railway and roads built; sugar industry expanded under British rule; legal and education system reformed; Mauritius remained a major sugar producer. 2 marks per well-explained effect; 1 mark for bare statement.	6
4(a)	Battle of Grand Port (1810)	1
4(b)	Any TWO: indentured workers signed a contract (enslaved people did not); indentured workers received a small wage (enslaved people received nothing); indentured workers were legally free (enslaved people were property); the indenture system had an end date (slavery had no fixed end). (1 mark each)	2
4(c)	1921	1
4(d)	English	1
5	Award 2 marks per specific change explained (up to 4 marks) + 1 mark for coherence. Changes may include: population became majority of Indian origin; Hindu, Muslim and Tamil festivals became part of Mauritian culture; new foods, clothing, languages (Bhojpur) introduced; religious buildings (temples, mosques) built; sugar estates developed; cultural traditions (music, dance) brought from India. Partial credit for bare mention.	5

Q	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
6(a)	Sugar cane	1
6(b)	Coastal fishing and marine life	1
6(c)	Fishing and seafood	1
7(a)	Any THREE with use, e.g.: Sugar cane — for making sugar and rum; Fish — food and export income; Coral reef — protects the coast, supports fishing; Fresh water — for drinking and farming; Basalt/stone — building material; Tea — grown in highlands, exported. (1 mark each resource + use pair)	3
7(b)	Advantage: steady income / established industry / expertise / large workforce (1 mark). Disadvantage: if sugar prices fall the whole economy suffers / monoculture damages soil / less variety of food grown (1 mark).	2
7(c)	Mauritius's natural beauty — beaches, coral reefs, mountains, wildlife — attracts tourists and earns money for the country (1 mark for developed reason).	1
8(a)	Any valid protection: create marine protected areas / ban overfishing / reduce plastic waste entering the sea / penalise reef damage / promote eco-tourism. Award 1 mark for identifying action + 1 mark for explaining why it helps.	2
8(b)	Any valid protection: create national parks / reforestation programmes / ban illegal logging / breed endangered species in captivity / control invasive species. (1+1 marks)	2
8(c)	Any valid protection: ban single-use plastics / organise beach clean-ups / educate the public / provide more bins / recycling programmes. (1+1 marks)	2
9(a)	Diwali	1
9(b)	"Star and Key of the Indian Ocean"	1
9(c)	To manage and improve local services in a community	1
9(d)	The National Assembly (Parliament)	1
10(a)	A community is a group of people who live in the same area and share common interests/needs (1 mark). Any valid example of mutual help: helping neighbours during cyclones; sharing food; community work parties; religious organisations helping the poor (1 mark).	2
10(b)	Any two valid responsibilities with explanation. Examples: voting in elections — so that citizens can choose their leaders / democracy works; paying taxes — so the government has money to build schools, hospitals, roads; keeping the environment clean — to protect health and natural resources; obeying laws — so society functions safely; helping neighbours — builds a caring community. Award 2 marks per responsibility (1 for naming, 1 for explanation).	4
Total		50